

Protecting the Public:
The Uphill Battles for Consumer Rights through the Expansion of Responsibilities

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Individual Documentary
Process Paper
500 Words

Process Paper

When I discovered this year's NHD theme, "Rights & Responsibilities in History," a vivid memory from second grade flooded my mind: a "class rules" poster outlining student's rights and responsibilities. This simple concept stuck with me, as I've always believed that responsibilities accompany rights to keep society running smoothly.

As a 15-year-old meat lover, I'm often frustrated by how long my mom spends reading nutrition labels on products in grocery stores. She always says, "It's our right to know what's in our food and avoid unhealthy ingredients". Her words inspired me to explore consumer rights and the responsibilities they entail through my documentary, "*Protecting the Public: The Uphill Battles for Consumer Rights through the Expansion of Responsibilities*".

I began by reviewing relevant literature, using resources like *Harvey Wiley*, *Theodore Roosevelt*, and *the Federal Regulation of Food and Drugs* from Harvard Library to map key events and figures in food safety reform. Then, I consulted diverse primary and secondary sources, including *The Dignity of Chemistry*, to understand Dr. Wiley's perspective as a consumer rights activist. To obtain more information, I read many papers and books from JSTOR and Library of Congress. I additionally found useful resources in the local library. The research process, which was both exciting and challenging, helped me understand early 20th-century food safety policies and their effects on Americans' rights and responsibilities. It also strengthened my research and critical thinking skills.

In my research, I focused on answering three key questions: 1) What was the historical path to food and drug safety reform? 2) Who were the major players involved? 3) How did "rights and responsibilities" shape this progress? I structured my documentary by examining 19th-century scandals, the journey to the 1906 Food and Drug Act, and this reform's long-term impacts. My documentary development process began with crafting a compelling script and pairing it with suitable archival media and narration to bring this historical journey for consumer rights to life. I enhanced it by adding unique sound effects and background music to better engage the audience. This creative process was truly challenging. It took me over four months to complete, and I became a more patient and detail-oriented researcher in the process.

My thesis argues that the journey to the 1906 Pure Food and Drug Act was driven by growing public awareness of the restrictions of consumer rights, investigative journalism, and mounting evidence of industries failing to execute their responsibilities. These reforms played a significant role in history, addressing a universal issue in food and drug safety to uphold every consumer's rights. I analyze this historical journey through multiple perspectives, including those of manufacturers, the U.S. government, activist groups, and Theodore Roosevelt. I claim that ensuring food safety and protecting consumer rights isn't solely the responsibility of businesses, governments, and organizations—it's everyone's responsibility. Even individuals such as journalists, scientists, and advocates were driven by the collective responsibility of passing federal reforms. These reforms have a lasting impact on American society and continue to influence our lives today.

Annotated Bibliography

Primary Sources

Book

Accum, Friedrich Christian. *A Treatise on Adulterations of Food and Culinary Poisons: Exhibiting the Fraudulent Sophistications of Bread, Beer, Wine, Spirituous Liquors, Tea, Coffee, Cream, Confectionery, Vinegar, Mustard, Pepper, Cheese, Olive Oil, Pickles and Other Articles Employed in Domestic Economy; and Methods of Detecting Them*. London: Sold by Longman, Hurst, Rees, Orme, and Brown, 1820.

Accum's book, found in the National Library of Medicine digital collections, is one of the initial, essential works that reveal food adulteration in the early 19th century. In my documentary, I used his book to showcase how he first exposed food adulteration and sparked awareness for food safety as one of the early explorers of food safety.

Adams, Samuel Hopkins. *The Great American Fraud*. Chicago: American Medical Association, 1907.

Adams revealed fraudulent advertising and non-compliance in the early pharmaceutical industry in the U.S., directly prompting public demand for stricter legal protections. As one of the muckrakers, Adams' work was crucial. In my documentary, I showcased his findings on food safety issues in the U.S.

Battershall, Jesse Park. *Food adulteration and its detection*. New York: E. & FN Spon, 1887.
<https://www.loc.gov/item/07026070/>, Accessed 24 Sept. 2024.

Battershall's work provides a detailed account of food adulteration methods and scientific detection techniques, offering a powerful tool for exposing adulteration in the food industry. This work helped me to understand the importance of scientists, as they fulfilled their social responsibility through technological innovation and directly contributing to the establishment of food safety standards.

Sinclair, Upton. *The Jungle*. New York: Doubleday, Page & Co, 1906.

By exposing the dark secrets of the meatpacking industry, Sinclair made a direct contribution to pushing for food safety reform in the U.S. I believe his book raised public awareness of consumer health rights and ultimately helped lead to the passage of the 1906 Food and Drugs Act, highlighting the unique power of literature in awakening social responsibility. I directly illustrated his exposes on food safety issues in my documentary.

Wiley, Harvey Washington. *The History of a Crime Against the Food Law*. Washington DC: H. W. Wiley, 1929.

Wiley's book meticulously records his struggle with food industry giants, revealing the conflict between commercial interests and social responsibility in the field of food safety regulation. In my documentary, I used his experience to demonstrate the social responsibility of scientists and the importance of legislation in protecting consumer rights.

Journal

Hassall, Arthur Hill. "Adulterations detected, or Plain Instructions for the Discovery of Frauds in Food and Medicine." *Journal of Cell Science* 1.20 (1857): 229-232.

Hassall's research journal published in 1857 revealed food and drug adulteration, marking progress in food science testing. I used his research findings of the 40 cases of child food poisoning linked to cheap candies as evidence to show how his work directly raised public awareness of food safety and supported the government in passing the Food and Drugs Act of 1875.

Johnson, Renée. "Food fraud and economically motivated adulteration of food and food ingredients." *Congressional Research Service Report*, 10 January 2014

This report thoroughly documents Wiley's struggle with food industry giants, revealing the conflict between commercial interests and social responsibility in the field of food safety regulation. This source, containing Dr. Wiley's personal experiences, helped me better understand how Wiley contributed to U.S. social responsibility of protecting consumer rights as a leading scientist.

Wiley, Harvey W. "The Dignity of Chemistry." *Science* 13.332 (1901): 721-732, <https://www.jstor.org/stable/pdf/1628920.pdf>, Retrieved 5 Oct. 2024.

In this scientific paper, Dr. Wiley emphasized the central role of chemistry in ensuring food quality and safety, calling on scientists and lawmakers to take more responsibility in protecting public health. I used this piece of his work in my documentary as evidence to demonstrate his effort in bridging the gap between the scientific community and policymakers to advocate for consumer rights and government responsibilities.

Law

Sale of Food and Drugs Act 1875, *UK Legislation*.

<https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/Vict/38-39/63/enacted>, Accessed 15 Sept. 2024.

As the first food and drug legislation in the United Kingdom (UK), it clearly states that consumer health is part of social responsibility. This source highlights the responsibilities upheld by the British government, as it enacted legislation vital to consumers' health. I used this Act as an important reference for the later Pure Food and Drugs Act of 1906 passed in the United States and a catalyst for later food safety regulation worldwide.

Federal Food and Drugs Act of 1906, *Office of the Law Revision Counsel*.

<https://usc-cdn.house.gov/view.xhtml?path=/prelim@title21/chapter1/subchapter1&edition=prelim>, Accessed 18 Sept. 2024

This official U.S. statute at large lawfully prohibited all manipulated or adulterated food and drugs and laid the groundwork for further 20th century food safety regulation in the United States, such as the U.S. Food and Drug Administration. I used this Act to help understand its greater impacts and long-term effects on food and drug safety regulation, allowing me to better structure the last few minutes of my documentary.

Newspaper

Leslie, Frank. *Frank Leslie's Illustrated Newspaper*. Vol. 39. F. Leslie, 1875.

https://archive.org/details/sim_leslies-weekly_1875-02-27_39_1013/page/402/mode/2up,

Accessed 20 Sept. 2024

This historical publication vividly records the adulteration practices in the food industry at the end of the 19th century and their impact on public health. It shows the key role of the public opinion in driving consumer rights protection and strengthening regulatory responsibility at the time. In my documentary, I used this newspaper publication to directly showcase public opinion of the swill milk scandal.

“How we Poison our Children”, *New York Times*. May 13, 1858.

https://timesmachine.nytimes.com/timesmachine/1858/05/13/78535562.pdf?pdf_redirect=true&ip=0 Retrieved 22 Sept. 2024.

This New York Times report on the “Swill Milk” scandal and its harmful effect on children exposed the dangers of the unregulated production of milk. I directly quoted it in my documentary to show the public outcry during this period of major scandals.

Secondary Sources

Book

Blum, Deborah. *The Poison Squad: One Chemist's Single-minded Crusade for Food Safety at the Turn of the Twentieth Century*. Penguin, 2019.

In this book, Blum narrates, in detail, the history of Wiley and his team’s fight against food adulteration. It helped me to understand how important “The Poison Squad” is in driving food safety legislation and helping establish the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA). In my documentary, I highlighted the Poison Squad as an important steppingstone to the institutionalization of the expansion of “responsibility.”

Coppin, Clayton Anderson, and Jack C. High. *The politics of purity: Harvey Washington Wiley and the origins of federal food policy*. University of Michigan Press, 1999.

Coppin and High’s book delves into how Harvey W. Wiley influenced the formation of U.S. food policy by driving food safety reforms, particularly in opposing food adulteration. The book provides a detailed description of the “Poison Squad” experiments led by Wiley, which not only exposed the threat of chemicals to food safety but also prompted public and governmental attention to and implementation of food safety regulations. This material enriches the content of my documentary, as it dives deeper into Dr. Wiley’s efforts as a pioneer activist.

Hilts, Philip J. *Protecting America's health: The FDA, Business, and One Hundred Years of Regulation*. New York: Knopf, 2003.

Philip J. Hilts’ book provides a detailed exploration of the history of the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and its relationship with the business community, focusing on how the FDA has played a crucial role in protecting consumer health and promoting food safety. From this

booked, I was able to trace the evolution of FDA regulations since its establishment and learn how scientists, the US government, and businesses have continuously expanded and developed their responsibilities in safeguarding public health and safety.

Hawthorne, Fran. *Inside the FDA : The Business and Politics behind the Drugs We Take and the Food We Eat*. Hoboken (New Jersey), John Wiley & Sons, 2005.

Hawthorne's hardcover provides a detailed description of the complex challenges the FDA faces in creating and enforcing food safety and drug regulation policies, particularly in balancing consumer health protection with corporate interests. I didn't directly use this material in the documentary, but I gained a better understanding of food safety and its connection to industry economics behind it.

Hanawalt, Barbara A. *The Ties That Bound: Peasant Families in Medieval England*. New York: Oxford University Press, 1986.

This book offers a unique perspective on how medieval society safeguarded consumer rights through laws and social norms. It illustrates how social responsibility and law influenced food safety and market transactions, despite the differences between the regulatory systems in the medieval and modern eras. Hanawalt's research reveals the implicit awareness of food safety in medieval market ethics, highlighting the role of social responsibility in early food regulation and providing historical context for the development of modern food safety regulations. In my documentary, I used the research on food safety in the Middle Ages in this book to formulate the beginning of my documentary..

Town, William G., and Judith N. Currano, eds. *Science and the Law: Analytical Data in Support of Regulation in Health, Food, and the Environment* Washington: American Chemical Society, 2014.

The book includes several studies on how to use data analysis to improve public health and food safety regulations. It specifically looks at applications in food quality, environmental protection, and public health. I didn't directly use this material in my documentary, but it enriched my research and helped me gain a better understanding of food and drugs safety regulations.

Wilson, Bee. *Swindled The Dark History of Food Fraud, from Poisoned Candy to Counterfeit Coffee*. Princeton University Press, 2009.

This book describes how fraud harms consumer health and how it has prompted public and government attention to food safety issues. Wilson uses historical cases to show how food fraud threatens consumer health and safety, which leads to stricter food regulation policies. I used the case of "poisonous candies" in this book in the 19th-century scandals section of my documentary.

Journal

André, João P. "Fredrick Accum: an important nineteenth-century chemist fallen into oblivion." *Bull. Hist. Chem.*, VOLUME 43, Number 2 (2018): 79-89.

João P. André's article reexamines the significant contributions of 19th-century chemist Friedrich Accum, particularly his pioneering work in exposing food adulteration. The article analyzes Accum's seminal work, *A Treatise on Adulterations of Food and Culinary Poisons*. This material

enabled me to improve my understanding of Fredrick Accum's history of activism through science and experimentation.

Brode, Wallace R. "Harvey W. Wiley and Our National Science Policy." *Journal of Association of Official Agricultural Chemists* 44.1 (1961): 111-115.

Brode analyzes Harvey W. Wiley's role in U.S. national science policy and its impact on food safety. He emphasizes how Wiley, through promoting scientific research and experiments, particularly the "Poison Squad" experiments, exposed the dangers of harmful substances in food and helped push for the passage of the 1906 Food and Drugs Act. This material enriches my historical research, as it helped me grasp the significance of Dr. Wiley's activist efforts.

Cole, R. J. "Friedrich Accum (1769–1838). A biographical study." *R.J. Cole B. Sc. F.R.I.C.A.M.I. Chem. E.* (1951): 128-143.

J. Cole's biographical study deeply explores the life of Friedrich Accum and his contributions to the field of chemistry, particularly his pioneering role in exposing food adulteration in the early 19th century. The article not only provides detailed information about Accum's background and career but also analyzes how his groundbreaking research in food safety influenced public opinion and public policy at the time. This material enabled me to have a better understanding of Fredrick Accum's life story and how he sparked new food and drug safety regulation.

Davis, James. "Medieval market morality: life, law and ethics in the English marketplace, 1200 – 1500". *Cambridge University Press*, 2011.

The article explores how consumer rights in the marketplace were protected through laws and social norms between the 12th and 15th centuries, particularly in preventing fraud and unfair trade practices. Davis provides a detailed description of how society regulated the quality of food and goods at the time, highlighting the emphasis on integrity and fair trade in medieval markets, and underscoring the moral responsibility in market behavior. I used the book's research on food safety in the Middle Ages to structure the beginning of my documentary.

Fox, William Lloyd. "Harvey W. Wiley's search for American sugar self-sufficiency." *Agricultural History* 54.4 (1980): 516-526.

William Lloyd Fox's article delves into Harvey W. Wiley's efforts to promote American sugar self-sufficiency and analyzes how his research intersected with food safety and consumer protection. I used this article to support my argument by emphasizing Dr. Wiley's commitment to ending food adulteration, benefiting public health, and pushing for the enactment of food and drug safety laws. His advocacy for the independence on sugar production aimed to protect both America's economic stability and public health, solidifying him as a key figure in my research.

Gaughan, Anthony. "Harvey Wiley, Theodore Roosevelt, and the Federal Regulation of Food and Drugs." *Harvard Law School DASH* (2004).

Anthony Gaughan's article thoroughly explains how the collaboration between Harvey Wiley and President Theodore Roosevelt helped establish the federal regulation of food and drugs in the U.S. The article explores how Wiley used scientific evidence and public pressure to work with the Roosevelt administration in crafting the landmark 1906 Food and Drugs Act. Through this book, I

learned about the different positions of various individuals in the process of promoting the food safety bill, as well as their relationships to each other.

Hart, F. Leslie. "A history of the adulteration of food before 1906." *Food Drug Cosm.* LJ 7 (1952): 5.
F. Leslie Hart's article A History of the Adulteration of Food Before 1906 reviews the widespread phenomenon of food adulteration in the 19th century and analyzes its impact on public health. The article discusses how food adulteration became a significant challenge for U.S. food regulation, driving the demand for stricter regulatory measures. I utilized this source to help me understand the general timeline of food adulteration prior to the 1906 Food and Drug Act. This played a role in the structuring during my documentary creation process.

Jackson, Lauren S. "Chemical food safety issues in the United States: past, present, and future." *Journal of Agricultural and Food Chemistry* 57.18 (2009): 8161-8170.
Jackson reviews the chemical safety issues in U.S. food, analyzing the impact of chemical ingredients on consumer health from a historical perspective. She explores the challenges posed by food additives, contaminants, and other chemicals in recent decades and offers insights into future regulatory trends and technological advancements. Through this material, I have gained a more comprehensive understanding of the food safety problems existing in the past, present, and future of the United States.

Jackson, Lauren S. "Chemical food safety issues in the United States: past, present, and future." *Journal of agricultural and food chemistry* 57.18 (2009): 8161-8170.
The article explores the threats posed by food additives, contaminants, and chemicals to food safety and analyzes how related regulations have evolved to address these challenges. Jackson also discusses current and future technological developments, such as new food testing methods, risk assessment approaches, and food safety regulation in the context of globalization. I used this source in my documentary to accentuate the impacts of food safety regulation, as reforms have led to significant improvements in government oversight and public health measures.

Levenstein, Harvey. "Revolution at the table: the transformation of the American diet" Vol. 7. *Univ of California Press*, 2003.
Levenstein analyzes the transformation of American diets in the early 20th century, particularly the relationship between the industrialization of food, rise of processed foods, and consumer rights protection. He reveals how the food industry, in pursuit of economic benefits, faced challenges regarding food quality and safety, which prompted public attention to food safety issues and led to the introduction of related regulations. I didn't directly use this material in the documentary, but I learned more about the relationship between food and the economy.

Markel, Howard. "Why America Needs a Strong FDA." *JAMA*, vol. 294, no. 19, 16 Nov. 2005, p. 2489, <https://doi.org/10.1001/jama.294.19.2489>. Accessed 11 Feb 2025.
Markel discusses the importance of the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) in protecting public health, particularly in ensuring the safety, effectiveness, and quality of food and drugs. He emphasizes how the FDA has historically responded to public health crises and continues to adapt to new challenges, such as the globalization of the food supply chain, drug safety issues, and

emerging health threats. This material helped me construct the second half of my documentary, namely the short-term impact of the 1906 Pure Food and Drug Act.

Redmond, Elizabeth C., and Christopher J. Griffith. "Consumer food handling in the home: a review of food safety studies." *Journal of food protection* 66.1 (2003): 130-161.

Redmond and Griffith's article reviews the relationship between consumer food handling behaviors at home and food safety, with a focus on safety issues in the home environment. The article summarizes numerous studies that explore how improper food handling at home can lead to contamination and pose a potential threat to public health. By analyzing common mistakes in home food handling, the article emphasizes the importance of consumer education in preventing food safety incidents. This material has provided me with a brand-new perspective on observing food safety issues from the angle of customer education.

Swann, John P. "How chemists pushed for consumer protection: The Food and Drugs Act of 1906." *Chemical Heritage* 24.2 (2006): 6-11.

Swann intricately discusses how chemists, particularly Harvey W. Wiley, exposed issues of food adulteration and drug safety, which helped drive the passage of legislation and ultimately transformed the U.S. food and drug regulatory system. This material enabled me to better understand the process of promoting the food safety act.

Schneider, Dean. "The Poison Eaters: Fighting Danger and Fraud in Our Food and Drugs." *The Horn Book Magazine* 96.1 (2020): 105-107.

The narrative recounts the historical struggle to expose harmful substances in food and drugs, primarily through the efforts of the "Poison Squad" and other scientists. These efforts led to the formation of food safety and drug regulatory laws. Schneider illustrates the history of the "Poison Squad," demonstrating how these scientists utilized experimental data to reveal issues of adulteration and food contamination, ultimately contributing to the formulation of the 1906 Food and Drugs Act. This material helps me understand the history of the "Poison Squad" and its role in catalyzing the development of new safety reforms.

Wu, Felicia, and Joseph V. Rodricks. "Forty Years of Food Safety Risk Assessment: A History and Analysis." *Risk Analysis* 40.S1 (2020): 2218-2230.

This article discusses how food safety assessment methods have changed over time. It focuses on the evaluation of chemical additives, food contaminants, and other risk factors, which have improved due to scientific progress and technology. The author explains how risk assessment helps decision-makers create better food safety regulations to protect consumer health and safety. This material is relatively straightforward, so it helped me quickly understand the progress of food safety in the United States.

Image & Picture

Australia, State Library of South. "Woman's Christian Temperance Union, 1900." *Flickr, Yahoo!*, www.flickr.com/photos/32600408@N06/3369315554. Accessed 10 April 2025.

This is a photo of an American Women's Christian Church group. I used it directly in the documentary to express their views on food safety.

Berliner, Emile. *Emile Berliner with the Health Committee including Dr. Harvey W. Wiley and Dr. Geo. M. Kober at a class of underfed children*. Henry Miller News Picture Service, Washington, D.C. Photograph. Retrieved from the Library of Congress, <www.loc.gov/item/berlp0032/>. This is a collection of photos of Dr. Harvey W. Wiley from the Library of Congress. I used his photos directly. These photos contain the appearance of Dr. Harvey W. Wiley at different periods. I used them in the documentary to present his viewpoints and history.

Ewing, Harris &. “FEDERATION OF WOMEN’ S CLUBS, D.C. LEADERS OF DELEGATION TO WHITE HOUSE: MRS. ELLIS LOGAN; MRS. H.W.WILEY; MISS E. SHIPPEN; MRS. R.C. DARR; MISS M. McNEILAN.” *Library of Congress*, 1970, www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2016865681/. Accessed 12 March 2025 This is a collection of photos of Dr. Harvey W. Wiley from the Library of Congress. I used his photos directly. These photos contain the appearance of Dr. Harvey W. Wiley at different periods. I used them in the documentary to provide a visual when presenting his viewpoints and history.

Harvey Wiley with scientific instrument. Photograph. *Retrieved from the Library of Congress*, www.loc.gov/item/2019642067/. This is a photo of Dr. Harvey W. Wiley conducting an experiment. I used it directly in the documentary.

Limited, Alamy. “In 1886, Citizens from Iowa Sent Postcards Petitioning to Label Oleomargarine. This Petition Was Addressed to W.E. Fuller and Is Part of the Historical Legislative Archives, Documenting Public Response to Food Regulations Stock Photo.” *Alamy*, www.alamy.com/stock-photo-in-1886-citizens-from-iowa-sent-postcards-petitioning-to-label-oleomargarine-54695668.html. Accessed 1 May 2025 This is the signature used for labels on butter that people asked for. I used it directly in the documentary, representing people's concern about food safety.

Limited, Alamy. “The Letter Outlines the Participation of Volunteers in the Poison Squad, a Historic Experiment Led by Dr. Harvey Wiley to Study the Effects of Food Additives. Volunteers Were Tasked with Consuming Potentially Harmful Food Additives as Part of Early Food Safety Research Stock Photo.” *Alamy*, www.alamy.com/stock-photo-the-letter-outlines-the-participation-of-volunteers-in-the-poison-54563373.html. Accessed 12 Feb 2025 This is a letter written from someone to Dr. Harvey W. Wiley. The writer hopes to be able to participate in the Poison Squad. I used this letter directly in the documentary.

Michael Lathrop 7 min reading, et al. “What Are FDA and Probiotics Regulations? Are There Any FDA-Approved Probiotics Supplements? Learn about the Relationship between FDA and Probiotics.” Ombre, www.ombrelab.com/blogs/heart/faqs-about-fda-and-probiotics. Accessed 12 Feb 2025

This website documents the work and tasks done by the FDA at its inception. I used it in the documentary to show how the FDA fulfilled their duties.

Service, Bain News. “Dr. H.W. Wiley in Pittsburgh.” *Library of Congress*, 1970, www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2014686519/. Accessed 12 Feb 2025

This is a collection of photos of Dr. Harvey W. Wiley from the Library of Congress. These photos contain the appearance of Dr. Harvey W. Wiley at different time periods. I used them in the documentary as a visual to help present his viewpoints and history.

The U.S. Food and Drug Administration. “Bureau of Chemistry Inspectors.” *Flickr, Yahoo!*, 12 March 2025, www.flickr.com/photos/fdaphotos/4900987603. Accessed 12 March 2025

This image shows the specialists and inspectors employed by the FDA when the organization was first created. I used it in the documentary to show the ways in which the FDA fulfilled their duties.

“Review: Uncle Sam at Our Dinner Table Is Subject of Delightful, Illuminating CDC Museum Exhibit.” *ARTS ATL*, www.artsatl.org/whats-cooking-uncle-sam/. Accessed 12 March 2025

This website highlights the short-term impacts of growing public awareness on food adulteration. I did not use the image it in the documentary directly, but it helped me better understand the effects of the 1906 Pure Food and Drug Act.

“Research in the Private Sector.” *Omeka RSS*, www.nal.usda.gov/exhibits/speccoll/exhibits/show/the-american-dairy-industry/research-in-the-private-sector. Accessed 12 March 2025

This website documents the work and tasks done by inspectors employed by the FDA who carry out the agency’s duties. I presented the images used on the website in my documentary to emphasize the FDA’s role in ensuring food and drugs safety.

“U.S. National Archives.” *Flickr, Yahoo!*, 12 March 2025, www.flickr.com/photos/usnationalarchives/page96. Accessed 12 May 2025. Commissioner, Office of the. “Mary Engle Pennington.” *U.S. Food and Drug Administration, FDA*, www.fda.gov/about-fda/fda-history-exhibits/mary-engle-pennington-cold-chain-food-safety. Accessed 12 March 2025

The image included in this website shows a Baltimore inspector examining a dirty agricultural facility. This helped me better understand the importance of the FDA in ensuring the safety of approved food, drink, and drugs.

“[President Theodore Roosevelt Delivering a Speech at Biddeford, Maine].” *SMU*, digitalcollections.smu.edu/digital/collection/bud/id/46/. Accessed 18 Feb 2025

This is a photo of the president Theodore Roosevelt. I used it directly in the documentary to present his viewpoint.

“Are We Living in the Gilded Age 2.0 ?” *History.Com, A&E Television Networks*, 18 Feb. 2025, www.history.com/articles/second-gilded-age-income-inequality. Accessed 18 Feb 2025

This is a famous cartoon from the Gilded Age in the United States, satirizing the capitalists' disregard for people's rights during the Gilded Age. I placed it in my documentary to highlight the contradiction between the responsibility of food enterprises and the rights of consumers.

Report

Wiley, Harvey W. "*Harvey W. Wiley: Pioneer Consumer Activist.*" FDA Consumer magazine The Centennial Edition, January-February 2006

In this report published by FDA Consumer magazine, Harvey W. Wiley was reviewed as the first commissioner of the Food and Drug Administration, where he became known as the "Father of the Pure Food and Drugs Act". This source provided me with a good overview of Dr. Wiley's journey as a consumer rights pioneer, emphasizing his innovations and contributions to advancing food safety laws and drug regulation.

U.S. Customs and Border Protection. *The Mexican-American War Brings Regulation on Drug Importation.* 24 July 2014.

David D. McKinney's article explores how the Mexican-American War prompted the U.S. to start stricter regulation of drug imports. During the war, a large number of drugs from Mexico entered the U.S. market, some of which were untested and posed a threat to public health. I used this article in the first section of my documentary, where I discussed 19th century food and drug scandals. With this source, I highlighted the pressing need for better drug regulations at the time, as these untested drugs were the leading cause of deaths in the Mexican-American war.

Website

History.com Editors. "Tenements - Definition, Housing & New York City | HISTORY." *HISTORY*, 22 Apr. 2010, www.history.com/articles/tenements.

This article analyzes the living conditions in New York City's tenements from a historical perspective and their impact on health, further illustrating how unsafe food exacerbates social inequality. I used the materials included in this article to support the importance of food safety legislation and its social significance in protecting consumer rights, and this helped me to structure my documentary.

Lim, Alexa. "Borax: It's What's for Dinner." *Science Friday*, 10 Oct. 2018, www.sciencefriday.com/segments/the-chemist-and-the-poison-squad-that-fought-for-food-safety/. Accessed 15 Jan. 2025.

Lim's article focuses on the "Poison Squad" experiments at the end of the 19th century, which aimed to reveal the harmful effects of chemical additives in food, particularly the use of borax. The article details how scientists, led by Harvey Wiley, used self-experimentation to demonstrate to the public and the government the potential dangers of these substances. The information from this article was highlighted in my documentary as a key event in the uphill battles for consumer rights.

Lewis, Carol. "The "Poison Squad" and the Advent of Food and Drug Regulation." *FDA Consumer*, vol. 36, no. 6, 2002, pp. 12–5, pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/12523294/. Accessed 15 Jan. 2025

The "Poison Squad" was a research group led by Harvey W. Wiley that aimed to promote public awareness of food safety by testing and exposing harmful chemicals in food. Their experiments directly contributed to the passage of the 1906 Food and Drugs Act, marking the official start of food and drug regulation in the United States. I used this directly in the creation of my documentary.

Moss, Tyler. "The 19th-Century Swill Milk Scandal That Poisoned Infants with Whiskey Runoff."

Atlas Obscura, Atlas Obscura, 27 Nov. 2017,

www.atlasobscura.com/articles/swill-milk-scandal-new-york-city, Accessed 12 Jan. 2025

In this article, Moss details the background and impact of the 19th-century "swill milk" scandal in New York City. It provided me with more details on the Swill Milk Scandal, highlighting the severe threat to consumer health posed by an unregulated food industry, sparking widespread public concern about food safety.

"The Path to Food Safety." *DocsTeach*, 1970,

www.docsteach.org/activities/printactivity/the-path-to-food-safety. Accessed 21 Dec. 2024.

This collection of sources reveals the social changes behind food safety legislation, emphasizing the key role of collaboration between scientists and the government. It provides a clear historical framework for understanding the origins of modern food safety systems and further strengthens the significance of expanding social responsibility in protecting consumer health.